Preparing for Your VA Claim Evaluation

A checklist for your independent mental health evaluation with Dr. Cherich

A complete picture makes for clear, thorough documentation. Gather what you can; if something is missing, bring what you have and we'll talk it through.

Records to gather

- ☐ DD-214 (or other proof of service)
- ☐ Service treatment records, if you have them
- ☐ Any VA rating decisions, denial letters or C&P exam results
- ☐ Current mental health treatment records (VA or private)
- ☐ A list of current medications and providers
- ☐ Your claim or appeal paperwork, if already filed

Things to think about beforehand

- ☐ The events or conditions of service you connect to your symptoms (dates and places help)
- ☐ How your symptoms affect work, relationships, sleep and daily life
- ☐ When symptoms started and how they have changed
- ☐ Optional: statements from family or fellow service members who have seen the changes

What happens at the evaluation

- A structured clinical interview by telehealth, usually 60–90 minutes
- Review of the records you provide, and validated assessment tools where appropriate (for example, the PCL-5 for PTSD)
- Written documentation (evaluation report, DBQ, nexus letter or IMO, depending on what your claim needs), typically 5–10 business days after your session

Good to know: Dr. Cherich provides independent clinical evaluations and documentation. She does not file or represent VA claims, and no evaluation can guarantee a particular rating. For free help filing, contact an accredited veterans service organization (VSO), claims agent or attorney; you can search accredited representatives on VA.gov.

Ready to schedule? Call 301-956-3185 or visit cherishconsulting.com/veterans-evaluations. Telehealth across Tennessee and Virginia.